

Chris L. Barker, Ph.D.

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Citizenship: United States

[SSRN Author Page](#)

Research interests

Public Choice Economics, Education, Health, Political Science, Sports

Employment

- | | |
|----------------|--|
| 2019 – Present | Harding University – Searcy, Arkansas
Assistant Professor of Economics and Finance |
| 2005 – 2019 | National Federation of Independent Business – Nashville, Tennessee
Managing Director of Compliance |

Education

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| 2021 – 2025 | Middle Tennessee State University – Murfreesboro, Tennessee
PhD in Economics
Mentors: Professors Daniel J. Smith, Ennio E. Piano, and Charles L. Baum |
| 2014 – 2016 | Middle Tennessee State University – Murfreesboro, Tennessee
Masters of Business Administration |
| 2003 – 2009 | Middle Tennessee State University – Murfreesboro, Tennessee
MA in History
Mentors: Professors Amy L. Sayward, Jerry Brookshire |
| 1988 – 1993 | Harding University – Searcy, Arkansas
BBA in Management and Accounting |

Working Papers

- 2026 **Shall We Play a Game? AI Simulation Usage in an International Finance Course**
Chris L. Barker.
- 2026 **Has NIL Nationalized College Football Recruiting? Evidence from Geographic Recruiting Patterns**
Chris L. Barker.
- 2025 **Capitalism and Wealth Concentration, 2000-2019**
Chris L. Barker, Daniel J. Smith..
[SSRN Link](#)
- 2024 **The Impact of the Bowl Championship Series on Competitive Balance in Major College Football**
Chris L. Barker, Daniel J. Smith.
[SSRN Link](#)
- 2023 **Property Rights and Economic Teaching: An Examination of Economics Textbooks**
Chris L. Barker.

Teaching experience

ECON 2010	Principles of Macroeconomics
ECON 2020	Principles of Microeconomics
FIN 3430	Managerial Finance
FIN 3440	Principles of Investments
FIN 3550	Real Estate Finance
FIN 3850	Risk Analysis and Insurance
FIN 4350	International Financial Management
FIN 4450	Advanced Financial Management

Presentations

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| June 2026 | "Shall We Play A Game?" AI Simulation and the Future of Finance Education
<i>Christian Scholars' Conference, Pepperdine University, Malibu, California</i> |
| February 2026 | From Gulags to Grace: Communism's War with Christianity
<i>Harding University Liberty and Character Forum, Searcy, AR</i> |
| October 2024 | Thinking Economically
<i>Harding University Colloquium on the Liberal Arts, Searcy, AR</i> |

University committees and service

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| August 2020 –
Present | University Academic Assessment Committee (College of Business Administration, representative) |
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Professional memberships

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| 2025 – Present | American Economic Association |
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Technical skills

Programming languages

Proficient in: R programming language, Quarto, Stata

Familiar with: Python

Software

LaTeX, Git